White Paper 07 — Client, Multiplayer, Communication, and Output

PDF export generated from 70_Client_Multiplayer_Output/WP_07_Client_Multiplayer_Communication_and_Output.md

Plain definition

This subsystem controls how players interact with AGE, how multiple players share state, how communication is scoped, and how verified output is displayed.

Problem addressed

Multiplayer narrative fails when players see inconsistent state, act out of order, or communicate without scope. AGE needs explicit sync, visibility, and communication rules.

Responsibility

The client layer owns input modes, choice presentation, free text, ruling requests, sync state, spotlight control, communication channels, voice/display options, replay access, and moderation/audit views.

Troupe model

The first multiplayer unit is a troupe: a bounded group sharing state, timing, authority policy, and visibility. Troupe isolation protects state coherence and permits table-specific policy.

Communication

Communication should respect spatial proximity, channel, directive, character voice, visibility, and moderation logging. Original user text should remain available for audit where moderation requires it.

Reward

Players get natural-language agency without losing shared reality.

Risk

Poor UI can hide why something happened, interrupt pacing, or expose too much system machinery.

Mitigation

Separate player-facing prose from optional details: quick explanation, ruling details, replay/audit view, and referee tools.

Success criteria

Multiple players can act, communicate, receive rulings, and remain synchronized around one coherent troupe state.